had to wait a quarter of an hour for my chance. The ball rolled to me just outside the penalty area and I whipped it, first time, past David Seaman. The feeling wasn't what I'd been expecting at all. I jumped up to celebrate but, at the same time, it seemed like I should be going over and having a laugh about it with Dave. We've joked our way through shooting practice at so many England training sessions together. If he reads my intention, he'll just catch the ball as if to say: Is that the best you can do? If he doesn't, and I score, then I'll give him grief. Half of me that night at Villa Park wanted to run over, jump on Dave's back, and give him a shake. I was really pleased with the goal but because of everything that came later in the game, it's only me that seems to remember it now.

When you score in a big game, you always hope your goal will be the winner. But Arsenal came back strong, and in the second half things seemed to be going their way. Dennis Bergkamp scuffed an equalizer and, five minutes after that, Roy Keane was sent off for a second yellow card. You could tell they thought they had us. All we could do was dig in and hope for the best. *Whatever happens, they're not going to score*.

Then, with almost no time left, Arsenal got a penalty, down at the end where I'd scored my goal, which seemed so long ago now it might have been in a different game. *Oh, no. Bergkamp's taking it. He never misses*.

Lucky for us, Peter Schmeichel knew better and he dived to his left to save it. I ran up to congratulate him and put my arms around him.

'We're going to get a goal now!' he bellowed at me.

Then he pushed me away. I mean, really pushed me. I went flying. We had to defend the corner kick and I think everybody was too busy concentrating on marking up to notice me stumbling away.

The ninety minutes ended 1–1 and we went into extra-time. To be honest, it was a bit like a training game: attackers vs defenders, with Arsenal camped around our penalty area. But then, with about ten minutes left before penalties, Patrick Vieira—of all people, one of the best midfielders in the world—misplaced a pass near the halfway line. Ryan Giggs got the ball and just started running. Giggsy was one of the few of us who had any legs left because he'd come on as a sub after about an hour. He kept going and going, beat a couple of defenders, and when the ball bobbled off his shin it took him past Martin Keown, who was playing off him. Ryan was on an angle, to the left of the Arsenal goal. *He's got to pass it across the six-yard box now.*